

Cover Letter

Application for Community Engagement & Outreach Coordinator - Western University

To the hiring managers and specialists at the Arts and Humanities Department of Western University,

Now more than ever, amid rapid advances in technology and the mass adoption of AI, the future for the Arts and Humanities seems to be left in a confusing position. Many are left to wonder where human expression fits in an automated future. Yet, it is precisely within this landscape of uncertainty that the necessity for writers, communicators, scholars and storytellers becomes more vital than ever. The future job market will belong to those who offer what fancy technology cannot replace: the human touch and our eclectic ingenuity. SASAH, I believe, is uniquely positioned to prepare these indispensable future professionals, transforming creative and critical thinking into direct community action. My career has shown me firsthand how crucial the humanities are in the real world, whether in military public affairs, in research within business environments, or in consulting for nonprofits. I am eager to return to the campus and the department where my journey began to ignite that same curiosity and fervour in the next generation as your Community Engagement and Outreach Coordinator.

While SASAH thrives on creative expression, executing its vision requires tactical precision. Serving as a Public Affairs Representative within the Canadian Army has trained me to operate seamlessly under strict frameworks where discretion and crisis triage are daily realities. I advise senior leaders on strategy and manage incoming inquiries, regularly translating complex directives into clear updates for command staff. For example, when launching an educational partnership with Fanshawe College, I coordinated the partnership and guided the project through a rigorous approval process.

Currently, as a Research Associate at Western's own Ivey Business School, I work alongside international partners from the University of São Paulo and UNAM on complex initiatives in Indigenous Management and Organization studies. Navigating these global relationships demands a high level of cultural empathy, a skill I lean into as a trilingual communicator. Furthermore, I practiced this same level of precision when advising nonprofits such as the Boys and Girls Club and Lemma Academy, where I designed educational outreach programs, successfully engaging distinct groups like FIRST Robotics Canada and the Guyanese Consulate.

Watching Western change over the years, first as a student and now as a campus professional, has given me a genuine understanding and tremendous appreciation for our university's goals and impact on the local and international landscapes. I know the careful balance required to protect Western's reputation while working with a wide range of public personalities and varying interests. To the SASAH team, I bring a genuine eye for detail, a reputation for getting things done, and a fondness for collaborating across disciplines to ensure that we are flawlessly preparing the storytellers of the future.

Thank you for having read this letter and for considering my application.

Kindest regards,

Andres J. Mona